

Sift — Music Discovery: third-party content and rights

Documentary evidence for App Review, Guideline 5.2.3 · Submission ID 091bf87b-af03-442a-b5ac-61d0bcc6acf0

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Summary

Sift uses **no third-party audio or video streaming service other than Apple's own**. Every preview clip, every piece of album artwork and every catalogue lookup comes from Apple, through Apple's published APIs under this developer account. Full-song playback happens only through MusicKit, under the listener's own Apple Music subscription. The only other outside data is artist metadata (names, identifiers, genre tags, similarity scores) from the MetaBrainz Foundation's MusicBrainz and ListenBrainz projects. It contains no audio and is published under open licences that allow this use. Sift never downloads, stores, caches, converts or redistributes audio or video.

Service	What Sift uses it for	Basis for use	Evidence
Apple — iTunes Search API	30-second previews and artwork, streamed from Apple's URLs, with a link to the song on Apple Music	Apple's public API, used as documented	§1
Apple — Apple Music API and MusicKit JS	Catalogue lookups, similar artists, full-song playback and saving to the user's own library (subscribers only)	MusicKit key under this developer account and the Apple Developer Program License Agreement	§2 (key screenshot)
MetaBrainz — MusicBrainz	Artist names, IDs, aliases and genre tags. Metadata only, no audio	Core data: CC0 1.0. Tags: CC BY-NC-SA 3.0. Sift is free, with credit shown in the app	§3
MetaBrainz — ListenBrainz	Artist-similarity statistics. Metadata only, no audio	CC0 1.0 (public domain)	§3

No other catalogue, streaming or discovery service is used. Spotify and YouTube search links, which appeared in earlier builds, have been **removed**. Sift has no Spotify, YouTube, SoundCloud, Deezer or other third-party player, API or link. Other network services are not content: Supabase is Sift's own account backend (sign-in, friends, saved-song backup), and jsDelivr serves the open-source supabase-js code library (MIT licence).

1. Apple iTunes Search API: previews and artwork

Sift searches Apple's catalogue through the iTunes Search API (`itunes.apple.com/search` and `/lookup`). It plays the `previewUrl` clip and shows the `artworkUrl` image that Apple returns, directly from Apple's servers. Each saved song links to its page on Apple Music. Previews are never saved to the device or to Sift's servers. Documentation:

<https://performance-partners.apple.com/search-api>

<https://developer.apple.com/library/archive/documentation/AudioVideo/Conceptual/iTuneSearchAPI/index.html>

2. Apple Music API and MusicKit JS

Sift has a MusicKit key under its Apple Developer account. It is used to issue developer tokens for the Apple Music API and MusicKit JS v3. The private key is held only on Sift's server and is never shipped in the app. With the listener's permission (Apple's own MusicKit authorisation prompt), Sift plays full songs through MusicKit under the **listener's own Apple Music subscription** and saves songs to a playlist in their own

library. Sift never proxies, records or re-serves this audio. The screenshot below is from Certificates, Identifiers & Profiles → Keys, taken 25 Sep 2026: key 4NAPM3K3DP, "Sift MusicKit Key", MusicKit service, team Panagiotis Vlahos-Kitas (N6Y9JAG2XB).

Certificates, Identifiers & Profiles

Certificates	Keys +						Services
Identifiers	KEY ID	SERVICES	NAME	CREATED AT	UPDATED AT	APNS CONFIG	APNS ENVIRONMENT
Devices	4NAPM3K3DP		Sift MusicKit Key	2026/07/23	2026/07/23	-	-
Profiles							

Documentation: <https://developer.apple.com/musickit/> · <https://developer.apple.com/documentation/applemusicapi> · Apple Developer Program License Agreement: <https://developer.apple.com/support/terms/apple-developer-program-license-agreement/>

3. MetaBrainz Foundation: MusicBrainz and ListenBrainz (metadata, no audio)

Sift reads artist metadata from the public MusicBrainz web service and the ListenBrainz API to decide *which* artists to recommend. It never provides any audio, video or artwork. **MusicBrainz** core data (artists, identifiers, aliases, relationships) is public domain under **CC0 1.0**. Its supplementary data, including the genre tags Sift reads, is under **CC BY-NC-SA 3.0**. Sift is a free app with no in-app purchases or advertising, and it credits MusicBrainz with the licence on the You tab. It also keeps to the MusicBrainz rate limit of one request per second. **ListenBrainz** data is public domain under **CC0 1.0**.

https://musicbrainz.org/doc/About/Data_License

<https://metabrainz.org/datasets>

<https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/zero/1.0/>

<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-sa/3.0/>

4. What Sift does not do

- No downloading, saving, caching, recording, ripping or format conversion of any audio or video.
- No streaming from any source other than Apple.
- No links to, or embeds of, YouTube, Spotify or any other streaming service.
- No media files written to the device or to Sift's servers. Saved songs are stored as details only: title, artist, Apple IDs and links to Apple's own URLs. They are never stored as audio.

If any screen or behaviour still raises a question, please say which one and I will change it. Contact: petervlahosk2000@gmail.com